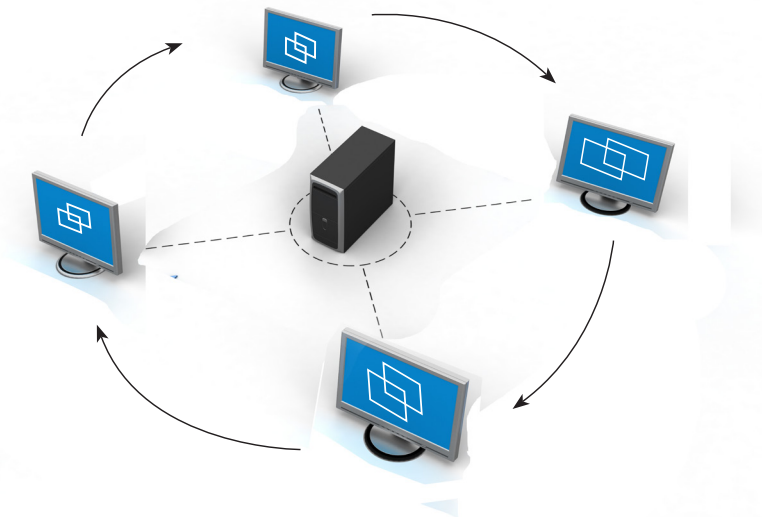


Remote Working and BYOD: Can Virtual Desktop Infrastructure Secure Your Enterprise?



not satisfied with the laptops provided by the company requested that they be allowed enterprise application access from their personal device. CIO teams have long been mulling over the bring your own device (BYOD) policy for their organisations, too.

VDI as a solution

Remote work and BYOD require a redesign of the end-to-end enterprise ecosystem. Virtual desktop infrastructure (VDI) is meant for just this. VDI technology has a long history, and has matured enough to meet any enterprise remote working needs. It is built from scratch with a focus on security, the user experience and agile operations.

Work from anywhere, any time, using any device requires an elevated security posture and can't depend on existing castle models. The zero trust security concept that has lately become popular in the security community rightly reflects and fits well into the remote work and BYOD scenarios.

Security vulnerabilities with remote work and BYOD

Figure 1 shows the threat landscape in remote work and BYOD scenarios. End user devices are susceptible to viruses and malware. Unless the user diligently takes care to keep the OS and applications updated with the latest security patches and leverages industry standard anti-virus software, devices are vulnerable and can easily get compromised. When these compromised devices are used to access enterprise resources, there is every chance the malware finds its way into the enterprise network. Once it gets

CIOs have wanted to enable remote working and bring your own device (BYOD) policies since long, but never took the tasks up as a top priority. Covid-19 changed that and compelled every enterprise to explore both. Network and security teams, which used to raise objections earlier, have realised that remote working and BYOD are inevitable, and are redesigning enterprise ecosystems to enable them. In this article, we will explore virtual desktop infrastructure (VDI) as a solution for securing enterprises that have implemented remote working and BYOD policies.

The pandemic has enhanced the demand for work from remote environments. As a result, OEMs, infra and cloud providers, application vendors, researchers, analysts, and service integrators have all come together to explore solutions and develop the products to meet this demand.

Lockdowns imposed due to the pandemic made enterprises quickly explore various options to enable employees to contribute to enterprise productivity while working from home.

Some companies purchased a large number of new laptops and couriered these to the homes of their employees. They installed VPN agents and set up VPN systems on a war footing. Though these offered a quick fix solution, they had serious limitations. With VPNs, the enterprise ecosystem is exposed to the outside world. Compromised end user devices and networks created many vulnerabilities, and opened the doors for hackers. Laptop procurement, too, had supply chain issues. Employees